

purely on web analytics determining how to increase traffic or conversion rates. In Dell you could be looking at how to optimise inventory. Therefore, you would be specialising in a specific domain.

❑ **Third-party analytics firms:** These are firms that are hired by companies for specific projects or for a certain time period. These analysts cut across various industries, thereby gaining a broad range of experience.

What makes people successful in this career?

Krishnan Venkata, with Latent View Analytics in Chennai, says that people who get into this field after five to 10 years of experience in a particular business domain have a definite advantage: “When you have an analyst with a pure mathematical and statistical background, very often the strategies turn out to be useless as it is completely devoid of on-ground business reality.”

Risks

If you want to change tracks (to get out of analytics) after spending part of your career in it, you would need to learn new skills. The applications to other industries are limited.

What are the alternate mid-career changes that are possible?

Since it is such a young field in India, there are few examples of people making mid-career switches. Very often, analysts take up further studies in order to upgrade their skills. The applications of these skills to another industry all together are limited. Many analysts go on to become consultants.

Krishnan Venkata, an analyst with Latent View says, “It is never easy to change careers, but there are natural roles in different lines of businesses to which people can transition. For a Sales / BD person, he could move to other high end services / product selling roles in firms in IT / BPO / consulting / research, etc. For a delivery person, it would be a harder shift but the natural cross-road is to be a domain expert / consultant. For example, an analyst in financial services analytics could grow to become a domain expert / consultant in the field of financial services.”

He says that the transitions people make at the management level are shifts to strategy consulting or account management in similar lines of businesses, such as KPO / BPO / IT services. There have also been people who move into equity research / financial analysis / investment banking. At the analyst level, since some of the skills developed are programming and statistical modelling, they could move to a domain or consultant role.

Resources for further reading

- <http://keysoft.co.in/training.aspx>
- http://www.learn4good.com/great_schools/computer_science_schools_in_india.htm
- <http://www.rediff.com/money/2001/sep/01riti.htm>
- <http://www.exforsys.com/tutorials/data-mining.html>
- <http://www.financialexpress.com/news/take-your-pick-nasscom-identifies-six-hot-tech-sectors/79935/0>
- <http://www.careernet.co.in/pdf/CareerNet-TEG-Analytics-Services-Study-2008.pdf>